

THE LIBERATION EDITION

I N W A R D

A P P L I C A T I O N S P E C I F I C A T I O N

*The complete flow of the application, its precise features,
and the design language that carries them —
every screen an argument for a slower, fuller life.*

PART ONE — THE FLOW

first launch · the daily loop · the week, the season, the year

PART TWO — THE FEATURES

exact behaviors, limits, timings and rules of every instrument

PART THREE — THE DESIGN

palette, typography, motion, sound, components, privacy

PART · ONE · — · THE · FLOW

One threshold, five rooms, no corridors that never end

The information architecture is the philosophy made navigable.

Inward opens to a single screen — the Threshold — which is not a feed and not a dashboard. It shows exactly what today asks of you and nothing else: the morning or evening Compass if it is due, Today's Opening if it is waiting, and one quiet line otherwise. From the Threshold, four doors and one switch:

THE THRESHOLD <i>Home</i>	Today's state only: Compass when due, the day's one Opening, one line of text. Never more than three elements on screen.
THE MIRROR <i>See</i>	The intake, the Extraction Index, your portrait, and the monthly re-look. Entered from the Threshold; visited rarely by design.
THE PLAN <i>Loosen</i>	Your active liberation thread, the dare ladder, Build One Thing, and the Craving Button's history of decoded urges.
THE LIBRARY <i>Awaken</i>	One Deep Thing, Paths of Awakening, the e-book, the four practices. One reading per day — the door closes behind you.
THE COMPANION <i>Counsel</i>	The guide. Opens from anywhere, ends every conversation, leaves no thread to pull you back.
THE QUIET <i>Switch</i>	Unplug, Detox, Stillness. Not a room but a state — when active, the whole app goes dark except one line.

Navigation rule: there is no screen in Inward from which you can reach more content of the same kind. Every path terminates — in the world, in silence, or in the closed app. The architecture has no loops, only exits.

F L O W · 0 1 · — · F I R S T · L A U N C H

The first sixty seconds — and the first hour

The entry bar sits near zero: before any question, one breath.

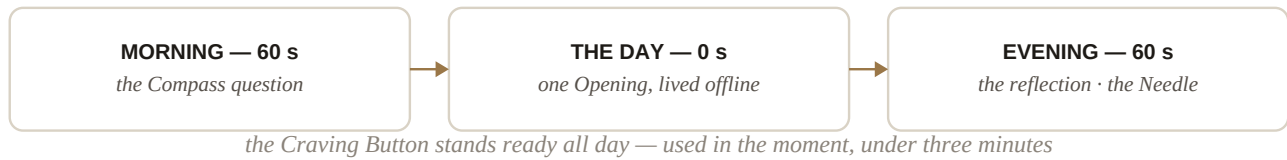


Rules of the first hour: the intake may be abandoned at any point and the app remains fully usable — the Mirror simply waits. No account is required; no e-mail is asked. If the intake surfaces signs of addiction or crisis (gambling, substances, compulsive sexuality, despair), the portrait pauses and the help screen comes first: local helplines and professionals, stated plainly and kindly, before any product feature.

FLOW · 02 · — · THE · DAILY · LOOP

Three touches a day, then the world

Total intended screen time inside Inward: under five minutes per day.



A 07:00 – 11:00 · USER · SET

Morning — the orientation

- **Trigger.** one silent notification at the user's chosen hour; opening the app at any time also begins it.
- **Content.** one question — “What will you give your attention to today?” — answered in one line or one chosen word.
- **Then.** Today's Opening is revealed: exactly one act drawn from the active thread — a swap, a dare, a practice, or a person to reach.
- **Exit.** the screen fades to one line and the app closes itself. Nothing else can be opened from this flow.

B DURING THE DAY · ON DEMAND

The day — lived, not logged

- **Craving Button.** reachable from the Threshold, a home-screen widget, and the lock screen. Full flow under three minutes (spec 06).
- **Companion.** available on demand for counsel; sessions end (spec 11). No proactive messages, ever.
- **Nothing else.** no mid-day notifications, no badges, no “come back” mechanics. The app's silence is a feature.

C 20:00 – 23:00 · USER · SET

Evening — the reflection

- **Content.** one reflection: did today move toward spirit — presence, love, depth — or toward matter — speed, accumulation, distraction? One tap on a spectrum, one optional line.
- **Evidence.** if the Opening was completed, one sentence is invited for the Evidence journal — your own words, in your own voice.
- **The Needle.** a single slow visualization of your 90-day direction. No number, no grade — a drift, like a compass settling.
- **Wind-down.** optionally hands off to the sleep ritual: screens dim, one closing line, the phone goes to bed before you do.

FLOW · 03 · — · WEEK , SEASON , YEAR

The longer rhythms

Liberation is kept alive by cadence, not intensity.

W EVERY WEEK

The Realignment — 10 minutes, once

- **When.** user-chosen day and hour; many will bind it to their Stillness period.
- **The Ledger.** with permission, the week's screen hours and tagged spending appear as a spiritual ledger: this is what you treated as ultimate, in practice.
- **The values beside it.** your chosen values — love, family, nature, craft, friends — each with the hours they actually received. The gap is the homework, never the verdict.
- **The Circle.** one written reflection shared with your circle of five to eight; one shared dare chosen for the coming week. No likes, no replies-as-performance — words only.
- **Output.** one adjustment to the week ahead: a single commitment, written in one line.

S EVERY 6 – 12 WEEKS

The Season — one thread at a time

- **Thread review.** the active extraction channel is re-measured; the capture band (Free / Leaking / Caught) is updated and shown beside the starting point.
- **Graduation.** a thread is closed when its replacement habit has held for four consecutive weeks — celebrated with one dark screen and one sentence, never confetti.
- **Next thread.** the Mirror proposes the next channel; the person decides. Build One Thing rotates or deepens at the same boundary.

Y EVERY YEAR

The Year — the reverse-retention letter

- **Your letter.** an annual, on-device summary in your own evidence: total screen-time change, threads closed, dares done, the sentences you wrote that mattered.
- **Our letter.** Inward's published reverse-retention report: what fraction of year-old users now spend less time on all screens, including this one. The metric the company lives and dies by.
- **The ask.** one slightly warmer annual letter from the Open Hand — the only marketing the product permits itself.

Cadence rule: nothing in Inward recurs more often than it must. Daily touches are seconds; weekly touches are minutes; the deep work happens in seasons. The calendar, not the notification, is the engine.

PART · TWO · — · FEATURES · OF · THE · MIRROR

Seeing the cage, precisely

01 INTAKE

The First Conversation

- **Form.** guided Companion dialogue or quiet questionnaire — user's choice, switchable mid-way.
- **Length.** 24–40 adaptive questions, ~15 minutes; pausable and resumable for up to 14 days.
- **Tone.** one question at a time, plain language, zero judgment copy; every question skippable.
- **Storage.** answers encrypted on-device; never transmitted; erased with one tap from Settings.

02 MEASURE

The Extraction Index

- **Channels.** twelve: feeds & shorts · series & streaming · games & loot mechanics · betting & speculation · pornography & boundary-less sex · substances · nightlife & engineered fun · shopping & materialism · outsourced thinking (AI-dependence) · abandoned skills · spectator life · starved relationships.
- **Scoring.** each channel scored 0–100 for depth of capture, computed from intake answers plus (optional, permissioned) screen-time signals.
- **Bands.** Free (0–25) · Leaking (26–60) · Caught (61–100). Bands are shown; raw numbers are available but never pushed.
- **Refresh.** re-measured at each season boundary or on demand; never automatically in the background.

03 RESULT

The Portrait

- **Form.** a single page, no scroll-past-the-end: where you are free, where you are leaking, where you are caught.
- **Mechanisms named.** each captured channel carries one line naming its hook — the variable reward, the engineered shame loop, the loneliness monetized — because compulsion decoded is compulsion weakening.
- **Closing.** one orientation sentence and one suggested first thread. Exportable as a private PDF; shareable only as the channel-free “How farmed is your attention?” summary, if the user chooses.

04 SAFETY

The Honest Limit

- **Detection.** intake patterns consistent with addiction, dependency or acute distress pause the flow before the portrait.
- **Response.** a help-first screen: relevant professional resources and local helplines, presented kindly and without alarm, with the option to continue when ready.
- **Boundary.** Inward states plainly that it walks beside treatment and never replaces therapy, medicine or clergy.

F E A T U R E S · O F · T H E · U N T A N G L I N G

Loosening, engineered

05 P L A N

The Liberation Plan

- **One thread.** exactly one extraction channel active per season (6–12 weeks); the rest wait. Focus is the feature.
- **Per thread.** one replacement habit · one daily micro-act (under five minutes) · a dare ladder of seven escalating real-world challenges.
- **Authorship.** the app proposes from a curated set; the person edits everything. Custom dares can be designed with the Companion.
- **Completion.** a thread closes after four consecutive weeks of the habit holding; relapse resets nothing — the ladder simply waits where you left it.

06 I N T H E M O M E N T

The Craving Button

- **Reach.** Threshold, home-screen widget, lock-screen widget. One tap, any craving — feed, bet, smoke, drink, porn, purchase.
- **Flow.** 90 seconds of paced breathing (4-6 rhythm, animated, no text) → one question: “what are you actually hungry for?” → choose: connection / rest / meaning / body → one concrete real-world action suggested → optional one-line journal entry.
- **Duration.** entire flow under three minutes; skippable at every step; never blocks the phone, never shames a relapse.
- **Record.** each use writes a decoded-urge entry (channel, hunger, action taken) to the on-device journal — the raw material of self-knowledge.

07 D A R E S

The Ladder of Courage

- **Shape.** seven rungs per thread, concrete and finishable today, each slightly braver: one screen-free meal → one headphone-less walk → one day of buying nothing non-essential → one true sentence to one real person → upward.
- **Rules.** no streaks, no failure states, no badges. A completed dare asks one question — “how did it feel?” — and writes the answer to Evidence.
- **Circles.** a weekly shared dare is chosen by each Circle; completion is reported in words, not checkmarks.

08 S K I L L

Build One Thing

- **Cadence.** one real skill per season — an instrument, a language, a craft, a sport, a garden, a repair.
- **Footprint.** deliberately tiny in-app: a named intention, one weekly check-in question, an Evidence entry. The skill lives in the world; the app only remembers it.
- **Anti-metric.** no minutes counted, no levels, no progress bars. The only question ever asked: “did your hands learn something this week?”

F E A T U R E S · O F · T H E · A W A K E N I N G

The ascent, instrumented gently

09 R E A D I N G

One Deep Thing

- **Cadence.** one reading per day, two to four minutes, typeset like a fine print edition — paper background, serif text, generous margins.
- **Canon.** deliberately cross-traditional: Heschel, Rumi, Dostoevsky, Black Elk, the Tao, the Gospels, the suttas, and secular and literary voices as first-class citizens. Delivered over the air as versioned, editor-curated data.
- **The end.** no swipe to the next. The screen darkens to one line: now go live it. The archive allows one revisit per day — wisdom cannot be binged.

10 P A T H S

Paths of Awakening

- **Shape.** guided journeys of 7–14 days; each day = one short reading + one question + one real-world act.
- **Catalog.** The Soul in the Age of Machines · Remembering What We Knew · What Is Enough? · Love as a Practice · The Discipline of Awe · Service as the Oldest Medicine · The Dopamine Detox (companion Path to the Quiet).
- **Completion.** writes to Evidence and ends with an unscored reflection — study that does not become life is not study.

11 C O U N S E L

The Companion

- **Voice.** warm, slow, cross-traditional, never preachy; asks before advising; honest about what is contested.
- **Powers.** untangles priority conflicts; sits through 2 a.m. cravings; designs personal dares; reflects your own Evidence back: “Three months ago you wrote the walk felt like waking up. You’ve stopped walking.”
- **Refusals.** does not diagnose; does not replace therapy, medicine or clergy; does not chat for chatting’s sake. When the real move belongs in the world, it says so and stops.
- **Limits.** sessions soft-close around twenty minutes; no conversation streaks; no nudges to return; crisis patterns route immediately and kindly to professionals and helplines.
- **Privacy.** transcripts on-device only, erased with everything else in one tap, never used for training or marketing.

12 P R A C T I C E

The Four Practices

- **Silence.** an optional sixty-second held silence gates the first app-open of each day — one breath animation, nothing to read.
- **Gratitude.** three named gratitudes folded into the evening reflection; one line each.
- **Awe.** one weekly prompt toward beauty or nature — “walk until you notice three things you’ve never seen on this street.”
- **Service.** one unrewarded act of kindness per week, suggested, never tracked beyond the person’s own Evidence line.

FEATURES · OF · THE · DAILY · RETURN · & · THE · QUIET

Tracking the turn, defending the rest

13 DIRECTION

The Needle & the Evidence Journal

- **The Needle.** a 90-day moving visualization of the evening reflections — a compass needle drifting between matter and spirit. No score, no graph axes, no comparisons with anyone.
- **Evidence.** a private journal assembled from your own one-liners: completed dares, decoded cravings, Path reflections, gratitudes. Searchable, exportable, erasable in one tap.
- **Use.** the Companion may quote Evidence back to you; nothing else ever reads it.

14 LEDGER

The Attention Ledger

- **Inputs.** opt-in screen-time access plus optional hand-tagged spending categories; both revocable any time.
- **Frame.** a weekly spiritual ledger, not productivity analytics: this is what you treated as ultimate, in practice — shown beside the values you chose.
- **Privacy.** computed and stored entirely on-device; no aggregate, no cloud, no exceptions.

15 THE QUIET

Unplug · Detox · Stillness

- **Unplug Mode.** one tap — “give me two hours of nothing” (configurable 1–4 h). Notifications silenced, the app dark except a single contemplative line; ends silently.
- **Dopamine Detox.** structured 7, 14 or 30-day programs of progressive fasting from the user's red list — shorter feeds first, then games, then all of it. Daily one-line check-in, Companion support, Evidence entries; ends with one question: “how does this feel compared to before?”
- **Stillness Switch.** one recurring protected rest period per week, designed once and defended by the app: during it Inward goes dark, the monthly ask never appears, and the wind-down ritual extends to cover it. Religion-neutral by name, welcoming to every tradition's day of rest.

16 ANTI-ENGAGEMENT

The rules the product obeys

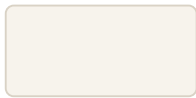
- **Notifications.** maximum two per day (morning, evening), silent by default, fully optional. No red badges anywhere in the system.
- **No loops.** no feed, no autoplay, no infinite scroll, no “related content,” no streaks, no variable rewards. Every screen ends; completed flows close the app.
- **The ask.** the monthly Open Hand screen appears once, only after a completed dare or reading, never during a craving or the Quiet; “not this month” is one tap, respected for thirty days.

PART · THREE · — · THE · DESIGN · LANGUAGE

Beauty is an argument

People do not reason their way back to the soul — they glimpse it.

THE PALETTE — PAPER, INK, BRONZE, NIGHT

**PAPER**

#F7F3EC

*the ground — warm,
matte, bookish*

**INK**

#1D1A16

*all primary text —
near-black, never pure*

**STONE**

#56504A

*secondary text and quiet
UI*

**MIST**

#D9D2C5

*hairlines, dividers,
borders*

**BRONZE**

#9A7748

*the single accent — one
use per screen*

**NIGHT**

#0E0C0A

*the Quiet, wind-down,
dare-complete scenes*

17 TYPE

Typography

- **Two voices.** a humanist serif for everything that touches the soul — readings, questions, reflections, the Companion's words; a quiet geometric sans for interface labels, in letter-spaced uppercase at small sizes only.
- **Scale.** large reading sizes (18–21 pt body on device), line-height 1.6+, generous margins; one type size larger than comfortable, because calm is legible.
- **Restraint.** no bold walls, no color-coded text, never more than two type styles on one screen.

18 MOTION

Motion & sound

- **Pace.** all transitions 300–600 ms, ease-in-out, breath-paced; nothing snaps, nothing bounces, nothing celebrates with confetti.
- **Signature.** fades to black are the brand gesture — every completed flow ends in a dark screen with one line of serif text.
- **Sound.** silence by default; one optional soft tone (a single struck bowl) for the morning and evening touch. No other sound exists in the product.

19 COMPONENTS

The component rulebook

- **Screens.** maximum three elements per screen; one action per screen wherever possible; every screen has a visible end.
- **The needle.** the only data visualization in the product — a drifting compass needle; no bar charts, no rings to close.
- **Iconography.** thin single-weight line icons drawn from one motif family: compass, door, thread, flame, leaf, moon.
- **Buttons.** one primary action in bronze text — never a filled attention-grabbing block; “not now” is always equal in size to “yes.”

Structurally incapable of extracting

20 DATA

The on-device architecture

- **Storage.** every personal artifact — intake answers, Index scores, journal, transcripts, ledger — lives encrypted on the device. There is no server-side user profile.
- **Backup.** optional, end-to-end encrypted backup to the user's own cloud account; Inward holds no keys.
- **Deletion.** one tap in Settings erases everything, immediately and irrecoverably — and says so plainly.
- **Analytics.** no third-party analytics or advertising SDKs in the binary, verifiable by inspection. The only telemetry is anonymous, opt-in crash reporting.

21 PROOF

The open covenant

- **Published persuasion.** every notification text, every ask screen, every nudge the product is capable of is published openly — anyone can verify the compass has no hidden magnet.
- **Reverse retention.** the annual public report: the fraction of year-old users whose total screen time, including Inward, has fallen. The company's only success metric.
- **The ask.** pay-what-you-want patronage (€3 · €8 · €15 · your amount), one quiet screen per month, identical apps for payers and non-payers, forever.

22 PLATFORM

Where it lives

- **Apps.** iOS and Android, feature-identical; offline-first — every daily flow works in airplane mode.
- **Widgets.** home-screen and lock-screen: the Craving Button, today's one line, the Quiet switch. The widget is the product's true front door.
- **Content.** readings, Paths and quizzes ship as versioned, editor-curated data over the air — no app update needed, no algorithmic recommendation anywhere in the pipeline.
- **Accessibility.** full screen-reader support, dynamic type to the largest sizes, reduced-motion mode that replaces fades with stillness.

“Every technical decision repeats the same sentence: the person is the point, not the product. An app against extraction must be structurally incapable of extracting — not merely promise to refrain.”

**Three touches a day.
One thread a season.
A whole life returned.**

*Every flow terminates. Every screen ends. Every path leads outward —
to the meal without screens, the walk without headphones,
the sentence said to a real person, the rest that no one can buy.
The design is the philosophy; the philosophy is the design.*

S P I R I T O V E R M A T T E R — T H E S O U L L E A D S , T H E W O R L D S L O W S

I N W A R D · A P P L I C A T I O N S P E C I F I C A T I O N · F L O W · F E A T U R E S · D E S I G N · 2 0 2 6